

O Christ, Our Hope, Our Heart's Desire 87

The musical score is written for a four-part choir (Soprano, Alto, Tenor, Bass) in 3/4 time. The key signature has one sharp (F#). The melody is primarily in the Soprano and Alto parts, with the Tenor and Bass parts providing harmonic support. The lyrics are printed below the vocal staves. The score is divided into two systems, each with a repeat sign at the beginning. The first system contains four lines of lyrics, and the second system contains two lines of lyrics. The music concludes with a final cadence in the bass part.

1. O Christ, our hope, our heart's de - sire, re - demp - tion's on - ly spring!
2. How vast the mer - cy and the love which laid our sins on thee,
3. But now the bands of death are burst, the ran - som has been paid;
4. O Christ, be thou our last - ing joy, our ev - er - great re - ward!

Cre - a - tor of the world art thou, its Sav - ior and its King.
and led thee to a cru - el death, to set thy peo - ple free.
and thou art on the Fa - ther's throne, in glo - rious robes ar - rayed.
Our on - ly glo - ry may it be to glo - ry in the Lord.

WORDS: Latin hymn, ca. 8th cent.; John Chandler, 1837
MUSIC: George Frideric Handel, 1741

BRADFORD
CM
Luke 1:78